T E X T

Walls, dreams and genocide: Zelensky invokes history to rally support.

He told U.S. lawmakers that he had a dream, invoking Martin Luther King Jr. to describe Ukraine's fight against the Russian invasion. He said to the British Parliament that his country would fight until the end, in forests and fields, a vow resonant of Winston Churchill's exhortations against Nazism. To members of the German Parliament he spoke of a new wall dividing Europe, echoing the Berlin Wall of the Cold War.

The passionate speeches, delivered remotely by President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine in his now-ubiquitous military-issue shirt, are part of a vigorous rhetorical effort to rally international support — for arms, or aid to his country, or sanctions against Russia.

Mr. Zelensky, a former comedian who ran a populist campaign to become president in 2019, is no stranger to performing, and his social-media missives and speeches have transformed him into a global symbol of his country's resistance to Russian aggression. The allusions, metaphors and allegories made by Mr. Zelensky point to a tailored strategy to emotionally appeal to nations and institutions and their histories.

Mr. Zelensky's soaring appeal to Congress, which prompted a standing ovation, framed Ukraine's fight against Russia as a battle to preserve democracy, freedom and the rule of law, calling on the United States' image of itself as a leader of the free world to defend those values.

Russia's attack, Mr. Zelensky said, was a brutal offensive "against our freedom, against our right to live freely in our own country, choosing our own future, against our desire for happiness, against our national dreams — just like the same dreams you have, you Americans."

He implored lawmakers to remember two moments of American trauma that involved assaults from the sky to empathize with Ukrainians fleeing missiles: Pearl Harbor and the terror attacks of Sept. 11, 2001.

He evoked the Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. to request antimissile defense systems, aircraft and a "no-fly" zone above Ukraine, a step that NATO allies have rebuffed, fearing it would escalate the war with Russia. "I can say I have a need. I need to protect our sky. I need your decision, your help, which means exactly the same, the same you feel when you hear the words, 'I have a dream.'" he said.

Mr. Zelensky capped the speech with a direct appeal to President Biden, tailoring his words to appeal to the United States' role on the global stage. "Being the leader of the world means to be the leader of peace," he said.

British lawmakers earlier this month invited the Ukrainian leader for the first ever speech in the House of Commons by a foreign leader. He took advantage of the address to quote Shakespeare and align himself and his cause with Winston Churchill, Britain's leader during World War II.

Ukrainians needed to defend their country against the Russians, just as Britons did against Nazism, Mr. Zelensky said. He vowed his country would never surrender to Russian tanks. "We will fight till the end, at sea, in the air," Mr. Zelensky said in front of the Ukrainian flag, echoing the phrasing of Mr. Churchill in a famous wartime speech: "We will fight in the forests, in the fields, on the shores, in the streets."

In his address to the Bundestag last week, Mr. Zelensky urged Germany to take stronger action against Russia, casting the decision as a metaphorical division between building or demolishing a wall — harkening back to the Cold War, an emotional period for Germans. "You are like behind the wall again. Not the Berlin Wall but in the middle of Europe, between freedom and slavery," he said. "And this wall grows stronger with each bomb that falls on our land, on Ukraine," he said.

He called for an embargo on trade with Russia, saying that its ability to keep trading, and keeping Ukraine from joining the European Union, was helping

REVISÃO UECE - INGLÊS

Moscow fortify this metaphorical wall.

With Canada, Mr. Zelensky mixed a personal, first-name appeal to Prime Minister Justin Trudeau with apocalyptic images of a Canada at war.

In his address to Canadian lawmakers, Mr. Zelensky referred to the country's leader simply as "Justin." And to help them understand Ukraine's experience, he said, he painted a vivid image of Canadian cities and landmarks under attack.

He asked lawmakers to envision Canadian flags replaced by Russian ones, Toronto's CN tower being destroyed by Russian missiles and schools being burned down. "This is our reality," he said.

He thanked Canada for its support, but said that what he really wanted was for the country to help bring about a no-fly zone in the skies above Ukraine and to force more companies to leave the Russian market.

From: www.nytimes.com/March 21, 2022

QUESTIONS

01. According to the article, Mr. Zelensky has become a symbol of Ukraine's resistance because of

A) his social-media missives and public speeches
B) his effort to save Americans
C) his career as a comedian in Ukraine
D) his actions in environmental causes

02. The speeches presented by the President of Ukraine were intended to

A) directly attack Russia's military bases
B) arm the population for war
C) reach monetary help from Europe
D) rally support from other countries

03. Talking with the German Parliament, the Ukrainian President mentioned a division in Europe referring it to the

A) American Revolutionary War
B) invasion in Russian territory back in 1917
C) exhortations against Nazism
D) Berlin Wall in Cold War

04. Mr. Zelensky characterized Russia's attack as a/an

A) demonstration of power, similar to Americans
B) act of happiness
C) brutal offensive against the freedom of Ukrainians
D) divergence from conservative ideals

05. Attempting to gain sympathy from lawmakers, President Zelensky remembered two historical traumas of America. One of them was

A) the World War I
B) the fight against Martin Luther King
C) the attack on Pearl Harbor
D) the presidential campaign of Winston Churchill

06. Zelensky said that "Being the leader of the world means to be the leader of peace", referring to

A) himself
B) President Biden
C) Martin Luther King Jr.
D) Winston Churchill

07. President Zelensky was invited to the House of Commons where he made history because he

A) took advantage of the British government
B) was the first foreign to lead a speech in that place
C) quote President Biden
D) verbally attacked Russia

08. The Ukrainian President phrased a famous wartime speech of Mr. Churchill, saying that

A) "We will fight till the end, at sea, in the air"
B) "Being the leader of Ukraine means to be the leader of peace"

C) "I can say I have a need. I need to protect our sky. I need your decision, your help"
D) “And this wall grows stronger with each bomb that falls on our land, on Ukraine”

09. Pronouncing to Germans in Bundestag, Mr. Zelensky urged them to

A) join the European Union
B) take stronger actions against Russia
C) build a wall
D) throw a bomb in Moscow

10. Trying to convince Canada of the horror from the Russian invasion, President Zelensky showed

A) interesting in Canadian's oil exportation
B) numbers of victims at the war
C) his goals for the future of his nation
D) apocalyptic images of a Canada at war

11. Another action that Zelensky applied to help Canada understand the Ukraine's feelings was

A) construct an image of Canadian cities under attack
B) ask lawmakers to replace Canadian flags for Ukrainian flags
C) show pictures of buildings and schools being demolished
D) recreate the horrors of World War II

12. It is stated in the text that President Zelensky’s strategy of using allusions, references to each country’s history in his speeches is meant to

A) highlight the fact that each country is different.
B) generate a sense of distrust among nations
C) trigger an emotional response in the audience
D) make the world hate Russians